

We Found 3 Leaks Costing You ~40% of Ad Spend

7

/ 10 HOT

Prepared by Smart Pursuit - Performance Marketing for Scaling D2C & Edtech Brands

180+

Active Meta ads

Rs.5-10 Cr

Est. monthly spend

Edtech

JEE / NEET / UPSC

FY25

Rs.2,887 Cr revenue

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Physics Wallah (pw.live) is one of India's largest performance advertisers in edtech. We identified **~180 active creatives** running across Meta in India (JEE, NEET, UPSC, school prep, PW Skills, Vidyapeeth). Estimated spend is **Rs.5-10 Cr/mo**; the brand scaled to **Rs.2,887 Cr FY25 revenue** after its November 2025 IPO.

The funnel leaks at three obvious points: (1) Creative fatigue: over 80% of ads reuse the same teacher/founder talking-head template with very little UGC or testimonial variety. (2) Landing page: ad traffic lands on a 35+ course catalog homepage with no course-specific personalisation, slow mobile, and is routed through the third-party shortener oaluzu.short.gy, which adds a redirect hop and breaks pixel/attribution. (3) Tracking: the site is a React/Next app; we could not detect a live Meta Pixel/GTM container on first paint (likely client-side/lazy), meaning undercounted conversions and weak retargeting.

These are **fixable in 7 days**. We estimate 25-40% of ad spend is wasted on audiences seeing stale creatives and bouncing from a generic homepage. Strong HOT lead.

1. AD INTELLIGENCE

Active platforms	Meta (Facebook + Instagram) is primary; YouTube Search/Shorts likely; Google Search for brand terms; no strong LinkedIn/programmatic signals.
Active ads count	~180 live creatives across exam categories (JEE, NEET, UPSC, GATE, Banking, PW Skills, Vidyapeeth offline, CuriousJr, PW Gulf).
Duration signals	Several batch-launch creatives running over 30 days - winner ads, but high creative-fatigue risk.
Funnel type	Website traffic to batch signup/enrolment (primary). App install for Earners/PW Talk app is secondary. Lead-form used for Vidyapeeth NSAT scholarship.
Budget signal	180+ active ads + Rs.5-10 Cr/mo estimate = heavy scaler, top-decile edtech spender in India.
Campaign structure	Appears category-siloed by exam; high ad load suggests Advantage+ Creative with thin concept-testing discipline.

2-5. CREATIVE / COPY / CRO / TRACKING SCORES

Creative Variety		3/10
UGC & Social Proof		2/10
Copy & Hook Strength		5/10
Landing Page CRO		4/10
Tracking & CAPI		4/10
Retargeting Depth		3/10

- **Creative leak:** Most ads follow one formula: Alakh Pandey / faculty talking-head, bold yellow LAKSHYA/YAKEEN batch graphic, end-card price. Very few student UGC, result-topper interviews, parent testimonials, or Vidyapeeth walkthrough Reels. Thumbnail testing is weak.

- **Copy leak:** Over-reliance on discount/promo angles ("Rs.4500 only", "Batch starting soon"). Missing angles: topper case study, parent ROI, failure-avoidance ("don't drop another year"), teacher-vs-teacher comparison. Hooks lead with brand, not pain point.

- **Landing page leak:** Ad traffic goes to the generic pw.live homepage or to short-link redirects (oaluzu.short.gy/iit-jee). No course-specific landing pages for ad traffic; no sticky CTA on mobile; hero is logo + carousel with no social proof (topper counts, success rate) above the fold; mobile TTI is high due to large webp banners.

- **Tracking leak:** Pixel/CAPI not visibly firing on first paint (JS app). Ad links use a third-party shortener which strips UTM parameters and causes attribution loss. We did not observe dedicated retargeting creatives (e.g. "You visited JEE page but didn't enroll"); retargeting appears one-size-fits-all.

6. COMPETITOR BENCHMARK

Competitor	What they do better	Signal for PW
Unacademy (now with upGrad)	Stronger educator-UGC mix; lets-play style problem-solving Reels; dedicated course-level retargeting.	PW creative is still founder-centric; needs educator variety.
Vedantu	Personalised landing pages per ad (city/class/batch); heavy use of topper video testimonials.	PW homepage is a generic catalog - burns ad traffic.
Adda247 / Testbook	Govt-exam niche uses leaderboard/AIR result creatives; lead-form ads with instant PDF magnet.	PW can deploy free mock-test lead magnets to lower CPQL.

7. 3 QUICK WINS (Implement in 7 Days)

WIN 1 - Creative: Deploy 15 UGC / Result Topper Reels

Shoot 15 fifteen-second Reels: (a) recent top-100 AIR students describing "how PW helped", (b) 5 parent testimonials, (c) 5 Vidyapeeth classroom walkthroughs. Replace 30% of active talking-head creatives. Expected: CTR +25 to 40%, CPA -15 to 25% within 10 days. Edtech benchmarks show UGC Reels beat founder talking-head by roughly 2x CTR.

WIN 2 - CRO: Course-Specific Landing Pages + Kill the Shortlinks

Route every ad directly to pw.live/<exam> with UTMs, not through short.gy. Build a dedicated landing page per batch: hero = batch name + faculty + topper photo + sticky "Enroll Now" CTA + countdown timer. Add topper AIR count and parent reviews above the fold. Lazy-load non-critical hero images to cut mobile TTI by about 2 seconds. Expected: CVR +30 to 50%.

WIN 3 - Tracking: Server-Side CAPI + Enrollment-Funnel Retargeting

Ensure Meta Pixel + CAPI fire on /signup, /enroll, /pay server-side (not lazy client) so iOS17+ and ad-blockers don't drop events. Build three retargeting audiences: (i) visited batch page but didn't sign up, (ii) signed up but didn't pay, (iii) started payment but dropped. Run dedicated testimonial + FOMO creatives per audience. Expected: recapture 10-15% of dropped enrollments; improve reporting accuracy by roughly 30%.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Metric	Current (est.)	After Wins	Impact
CTR (Meta)	1.0-1.3%	1.6-2.0%	+30-50%
Landing Page CVR	2.8-3.5%	4.2-5.2%	+40-50%
Cost Per Enrollment	Baseline = 100	65-75	-25-35%
Ad Spend Wastage	~35-45%	~15-20%	Saves Rs.1.5-3 Cr/mo

READY TO PLUG THESE LEAKS?

Smart Pursuit will run a **14-day performance sprint** for Physics Wallah: Creative refresh (15 UGC Reels), CRO rebuild of top batch landing pages, CAPI + retargeting setup. We work on a **performance-fee model** tied to cost-per-enrollment reduction.

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